
Dancing with Genie - Choreographed Movements Meet AI

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Abstract

Dancing with Genie: Choreography Meets AI is a 2-minute, 17-second AI-augmented dance video artwork that transforms a recorded live ballroom dance performance into an AI-generated reimagined world. The audience sees the original American Rhythm choreography preserved while costumes, architecture, landscapes, lighting, and special effects are regenerated around the dancers, accompanied by the original *Friend Like Me* soundtrack. The creative workflow combines computational audio analysis with Google Flow for video-to-video generation, Nano Banana Pro for image generation, and other AI and digital media tools for production and refinement. Engaging the NeurIPS 2026 Creative AI Track theme of *Agency*, the artwork explores how human and AI roles can be intentionally negotiated: the artist retains creative intention, choreography, judgment, and responsibility while delegating aspects of visual world-building to AI. The work asks what should be retained, shared, delegated, or consciously refused in human–AI creative collaboration.

1 Description of the Artwork

Dancing with Genie: Choreography Meets AI is a 2-minute, 17-second AI-augmented dance video artwork (Suzuki, 2026a) that transforms a recorded live ballroom dance performance into an AI-generated reimagined world. The source is the author’s American Rhythm showcase performance of *Friend Like Me* from Disney’s *Aladdin*, recorded on July 18, 2026, in which the author performed Princess Jasmine while her dance partner performed Genie.

The artwork investigates whether human dance figures and choreography can remain intact while AI regenerates the surrounding visual world. Human agency preserves the choreography and directs the creative vision, while generative AI transforms costumes, architecture, landscapes, lighting, and special effects.

2 The Roles of AI and ML

The source video was transcoded to DNxHR HQ, its PCM audio was extracted and analyzed for beat and tempo using librosa, and the video was segmented into 17 clips of approximately eight seconds. After one clip was discarded, 16 clips were transformed individually using Google Flow’s video-to-video generation capabilities; clip 007, which contained a choreographic misstep, was transformed using CapCut. The recorded performance supplied motion and structural conditioning, preserving the choreography as the artist’s protected contribution, while prompts delegated visual world-building—including costumes, architecture, sky, moon, dunes, and environmental motion—to generative AI.

The workflow assigned distinct roles to computational analysis, generative AI, and human judgment. Google Flow performed the principal visual transformations, while the author retained creative direction through prompting, evaluation, selection, rejection, and refinement. The regenerated clips were assembled in CapCut against the original *Friend Like Me* audio track. Nano Banana Pro generated the thumbnail image, Claude Code supported GitHub repository management (Suzuki, 2026b), and Perplexity served as a thought partner. Supplementary artifacts are documented in the project repository (Suzuki, 2026c).

3 How the Theme of Agency Is Addressed

3.1 The Definition of Agency

The author adopts a philosophical understanding of agency as the capacity to act intentionally, considered through five dimensions: *intentionality*, *choice*, *causal power*, *self-direction*, and *responsibility* (Schlosser, 2019). The artwork uses these dimensions to ask: *Which aspects of agency should or can be retained, shared, delegated, or refused?*

Ballroom dance provides an ideal medium for this exploration because agency exists within its ecosystem before AI enters the creative process. Performance already involves intention, artistic and technical choice, causal power through lead-and-follow, self-direction over body and expression, and responsibility among dancers, instructors, choreographers, judges, and audiences. AI therefore enters an existing ecosystem of negotiated agency.

The central metaphor is *Genie* from Disney’s *Aladdin*. Like AI, Genie possesses extraordinary transformative power within defined constraints; that power becomes valuable when guided by human intention and exercised responsibly. Throughout production, agency was intentionally negotiated across five dimensions:

Intentionality—Retained. Every regeneration served an artistic intention established by the author; AI did not determine the purpose of the artwork.

Choice—Negotiated. Imperfections in the source performance became creative opportunities. For example, clip 007 explored whether AI-assisted transformation could better represent intended choreography, while other clips used AI to extend expressive possibilities beyond the live performance.

Causal Power—Shared. Generative AI was given latitude over costumes, objects, architecture, landscapes, and environmental motion, but not over the fundamental choreography grounded in the recorded performance.

Self-Direction—Shared, with a Boundary. AI directed aspects of the imaginative visual world; the author directed the danced world and overall creative vision.

Responsibility—Retained by the Human Artist. Although generative tasks were delegated to AI, responsibility for the resulting artwork remained human. AI generated possibilities; the author determined what was prompted, selected, rejected, refined, and incorporated into the final work.

Like Genie, AI can grant extraordinary wishes, but it cannot determine which wishes are worth granting. The artwork argues that responsibility therefore remains fundamentally human: to determine what is retained, shared, delegated, and consciously refused (Schlosser, 2019). Genie thus becomes a conceptual bridge connecting AI, agency, creativity, and responsibility.

3.2 The Key Takeaway

The democratization of generative AI elevates rather than diminishes the importance of domain expertise and human judgment. When almost anything can be generated, expertise lies in determining what *should* be generated, what should remain authentically human, and where that boundary should be maintained. Authorship in the age of AI is therefore expressed not only through what is created, but through the quality of human judgment governing what is retained, shared, delegated, and refused.

4 Author Prior Work and Its Relevance to This Artwork

This artwork extends the author’s 2-minute, 11-second AI-generated film *Story of Hope* (Suzuki, 2025), which investigated whether generative AI could create recognizable ballroom dance figures and choreography through image-and-text-to-video generation and revealed limitations in reliably reproducing specific choreography.

Hypothesis. Can grounding generative AI in an authentic human performance preserve dance figures and choreography while giving AI greater latitude to transform the surrounding visual world?

Result. The experiment supports this hypothesis. Grounding AI in a human performance preserved the core choreography while enabling AI to regenerate the surrounding visual world. However, realizing a specific artistic vision remained dependent on human judgment through iterative prompting, evaluation, selection, rejection, and refinement. AI generated possibilities; creative direction and responsibility remained human (Schlosser, 2019).

5 Author Biography

Julia Fumie Suzuki is an artist and competitive ballroom dancer, data and AI leader, and wellbeing strategist working at the intersection of AI, creativity, and human wellbeing. She is the founder of Securely Wellbeing and Truly Human AI. Her prior creative work includes the AI-generated short film *Story of Hope* (Suzuki, 2025), which explored generative AI’s ability to create ballroom dance figures and choreography. Suzuki brings 14 years of consulting experience at Accenture and holds professional certifications from Google Cloud, NVIDIA, Microsoft, and AWS.

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